ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

General IT English

Conversation lab

12 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For IT operations, service desk, infrastructure, cloud, endpoint, security, and platform teams.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Service Desk Escalation: 'VPN Is Broken'

02 P1 Incident Bridge: DNS or Application Outage?

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11 Vendor Escalation: SaaS Degradation

12 Executive Update: Risk, Impact, and Decision

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.

2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.

3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.

4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.

5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Service Desk Escalation: 'VPN Is Broken'

A remote employee reports that the VPN connects, but the finance system will not load.

Roles: User / Service desk / IT operations engineer

User: The VPN is broken again. I cannot get to finance.

Service desk: I understand the impact. Can I confirm one detail: does the VPN show connected, or does the connection fail completely?

User: It says connected.

IT operations engineer: Then we should avoid calling this a VPN outage yet. It may be DNS, routing, firewall, or the finance app itself. Are other internal sites loading?

User: The intranet loads, but finance times out.

IT operations engineer: Thank you. I will update the ticket as 'VPN connected; finance app unreachable over VPN for one user.' I am checking whether this is user-specific or app-wide before escalating.

User: I will check the application status with the service owner.

IT operations engineer: Please keep the ticket scope precise while we determine how many users are affected.

Notice the professional language

DNS - The system that resolves names such as app.example.com to network addresses.

VPN - A protected tunnel that allows remote users or sites to access private resources.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

P1 Incident Bridge: DNS or Application Outage?

Multiple users cannot reach a customer portal after a DNS change.

Roles: Incident commander / Network engineer / IT operations engineer / App owner

Incident commander: We need a clear status. Is the portal down?

Network engineer: The application servers are healthy. DNS queries are returning the old address for some users.

IT operations engineer: Current evidence points to inconsistent name resolution after the change. Let's compare resolver responses and the change timeline, then assess mitigation through the authorized incident and change process. Lowering a TTL now would not retroactively expire records already cached elsewhere.

App owner: Can we say the application is not the cause?

IT operations engineer: We can say current evidence points to DNS propagation, not application health. We should avoid final root-cause language until we review the change timeline and resolver logs.

Incident commander: I will compare the resolver evidence with the approved change record.

IT operations engineer: Then we can evaluate mitigation without calling the root cause final too early.

Notice the professional language

DNS - The system that resolves names such as app.example.com to network addresses.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Access Review: Urgent Admin Permission

A senior manager asks for admin rights to fix a reporting dashboard before a board meeting.

Roles: Manager / IT lead / IT operations engineer

Manager: Just give me admin access for today. I know what I am doing.

IT lead: We want to help with the deadline, but permanent admin rights are not the right control.

IT operations engineer: We can assess a time-limited privileged session with approval, logging, and a defined task scope under our access process. We need to verify that the access expires as intended.

Manager: That sounds slow.

IT operations engineer: I can help submit the request and identify the authorized reviewer. I cannot promise approval or an exception before that review.

Manager: I will specify the task and duration in the request.

IT operations engineer: That gives the reviewer a clear scope for the access decision.

Notice the professional language

Least privilege can be framed as protection, not obstruction.

Offer a controlled path rather than only saying no.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Patch Window Negotiation

Security wants to patch a critical vulnerability; operations worries about downtime during month-end close.

Roles: Security / Operations / IT operations engineer

Security: This CVE is being actively exploited. We need the patch tonight.

Operations: Tonight is month-end close. If the ERP system is down, finance cannot finish.

IT operations engineer: We have two risks: exploitation if we wait, and business disruption if the patch fails. Can we test the patch in staging now, apply compensating controls tonight, and schedule production for the first safe window?

Security: What controls?

IT operations engineer: Restrict exposure, increase monitoring, block known indicators, and require rollback approval before any production change. If exploitation evidence appears, we move to emergency change.

Security: I will confirm the testing and business constraints with the service owner.

IT operations engineer: Record the authorized plan and escalation triggers in the change record.

Notice the professional language

CVE - A public identifier for a known cybersecurity vulnerability.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Cloud Cost Spike

Finance notices a 38 percent increase in monthly cloud spend.

Roles: Finance / Cloud engineer / IT operations engineer

Finance: Why did cloud cost jump? Did IT approve this?

Cloud engineer: Most of the increase is compute in the analytics environment and log retention in production.

IT operations engineer: The immediate issue is spend, but the operational issue is ownership. Several resources have no cost-center tags, so we cannot assign accountability confidently.

Finance: Can you cut it today?

IT operations engineer: We can stop idle non-production instances today, reduce excessive log retention where policy allows, and bring a tagging enforcement plan by Friday. I would not delete storage until owners confirm retention requirements.

Finance: I will identify resource owners before any cost reduction changes.

IT operations engineer: Include retention and availability requirements in the proposed actions.

Notice the professional language

Cost conversations need evidence, ownership, and guardrails.

Do not promise savings by deleting resources without retention review.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Kubernetes Incident: Crashing Pods

A containerized internal tool fails after a deployment.

Roles: Developer / Platform engineer / IT operations engineer

Developer: The deployment is broken. The pods keep restarting.

Platform engineer: The readiness probe is failing, and the logs show missing environment variables. We still need to check the container termination reason.

IT operations engineer: A failed readiness probe can remove a pod from service endpoints; it does not itself explain container restarts. Let's inspect termination events and any liveness or startup probe failures before assigning a cause.

Developer: Should we roll back?

IT operations engineer: Let's compare rollback and configuration repair using the incident procedure, evidence, and approved recovery options. The missing configuration is a finding; the full failure sequence still needs confirmation.

Developer: I will capture the termination reason and current deployment configuration.

IT operations engineer: Bring those to the incident lead so recovery follows the evidence.

Notice the professional language

The learner distinguishes platform behavior from application configuration.

Incident language should prioritize restoration, then investigation.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Phishing and Possible Account Compromise

A user clicked a suspicious link and entered credentials.

Roles: User / Service desk / IT operations engineer

User: I think I made a mistake. I entered my password on a weird page.

Service desk: Thank you for reporting quickly. Please do not change anything else yet.

IT operations engineer: We will follow the approved account-compromise response, including authorized containment and evidence handling. I will connect you with security through the established channel and explain the reporting steps.

User: Am I in trouble?

IT operations engineer: The priority is containment and evidence. Reporting quickly helps us protect your account and other users.

User: I will stay on the approved support channel.

IT operations engineer: Thank you. We will confirm the handoff to security and explain the next steps.

Notice the professional language

Good security communication reduces shame so users report faster.

Containment steps should be specific but not overly alarming.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Backup Restore Test: RPO Mismatch

A restore test shows that the system can recover, but with more data loss than expected.

Roles: Business owner / Database admin / IT operations engineer

Business owner: The restore worked, so are we good?

Database admin: The restore completed, but the latest usable backup is six hours old.

IT operations engineer: The restore completed within our recovery-time target, but the latest recovered data are older than the agreed recovery-point objective. We need to report those two results separately.

Business owner: I did not understand that difference.

IT operations engineer: RTO is the recovery-time objective. RPO describes the acceptable recovery point, commonly expressed as a time-based data-loss window. We need to review the recovery design against the business requirements and escalate the gap.

Business owner: I will confirm the business recovery targets in writing.

IT operations engineer: Then we can review the tested results against the agreed requirements.

Notice the professional language

RPO - Recovery point objective: the maximum acceptable data loss measured in time.

RTO - Recovery time objective: the maximum acceptable restoration time.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 09 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Change Advisory: Firewall Rule Request

A project team wants a broad firewall opening before a launch.

Roles: Project lead / Security architect / IT operations engineer

Project lead: We need to open the firewall to the vendor range today, or the launch slips.

Security architect: The requested range is too broad.

IT operations engineer: Can we narrow by source, destination, port, protocol, and time window? If the vendor cannot provide that, we should treat this as a high-risk exception with monitoring and an expiration date.

Project lead: What is the business impact of waiting?

IT operations engineer: Launch delay is one impact. The other impact is exposing internal services more widely than necessary. The decision should name both risks and the owner who accepts the exception.

Project lead: I will ask the vendor for the specific connectivity requirements.

IT operations engineer: We can assess the narrowed request through the normal security review.

Notice the professional language

A change review is not only a technical approval; it records risk ownership.

Use precise constraint language: source, destination, port, protocol, duration.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 10 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Post-Incident Review: Blame vs Learning

A failed manual change caused an outage. The team is reviewing what happened.

Roles: Manager / Engineer / IT operations engineer

Manager: Who made the change?

Engineer: I did, but I followed the old runbook.

IT operations engineer: The action matters, but the improvement question is broader. Why did the runbook allow a manual step without peer review, validation, or rollback verification?

Manager: So what should the action items be?

IT operations engineer: Update the runbook, add automated validation, require peer review for that command, and create an alert that detects the bad state within two minutes.

Manager: I will draft those actions with owners and verification criteria.

IT operations engineer: Review them against the actual failure sequence before treating the investigation as complete.

Notice the professional language

Root-cause language should include process and detection gaps.

Action items need owners, due dates, and verification, not just good intentions.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 11 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Vendor Escalation: SaaS Degradation

A critical SaaS vendor reports a regional degradation affecting SSO logins.

Roles: Business stakeholder / Vendor manager / IT operations engineer / Stakeholder

Business stakeholder: Why can't IT fix this?

Vendor manager: The issue is in the vendor's region. We do not control their identity gateway.

IT operations engineer: Our role is mitigation and communication. We are checking alternate login paths, monitoring the vendor status page, and collecting affected-user counts so we can escalate with evidence.

Stakeholder: When will it be fixed?

IT operations engineer: The vendor has not provided an ETA. I will give the next update in 30 minutes, or sooner if the status changes.

Business stakeholder: I will collect the affected-user counts and current service impact.

IT operations engineer: That will make the vendor escalation and our next stakeholder update more useful.

Notice the professional language

When a vendor owns the fix, IT can still own communication, impact tracking, and mitigations.

Avoid inventing ETAs under pressure.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 12 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Executive Update: Risk, Impact, and Decision

A CIO asks for a short update during a major email outage.

Roles: CIO / IT operations engineer

CIO: Give me the short version.

IT operations engineer: Email delivery is delayed for about 40 percent of users in this fictional incident. Current checks show queued mail, but we have not reconciled every message. We are investigating the filtering-service dependency with the vendor and reviewing approved continuity options.

CIO: What decision do you need?

IT operations engineer: We need an authorized decision on the available continuity options after security and service owners assess them. I will describe the operational effect and control implications of each option before requesting approval.

CIO: I will confirm the business owners needed for that decision.

IT operations engineer: I will bring the assessed options and keep the incident status current.

Notice the professional language

Executive updates should include impact, confidence, mitigation, risk, and requested decision.

A short update can still be technically precise.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

SHARED CASE

A ticket says "the system is down." The requester can sign in but cannot export invoices. Other functions have not been checked.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is ... . Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Which action fails, and what message do you see? I understand that sign-in works but invoice export does not. When did the problem start, and who else is affected?

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

SHARED CASE

Staff can reach an internal application on the office network but not through the VPN. Someone announces that DNS is the cause without testing it.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows ... .

This may indicate ..., but ... .

We have not yet established whether ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

The problem appears when users connect through the VPN. DNS is one possible cause, but we have not confirmed it. Let's record the tests and distinguish findings from hypotheses.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Identity, Access, and Permissions

SHARED CASE

A temporary analyst requests administrator access to download a monthly report. A reporting role may provide the necessary access.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you confirm the report and actions you need? The reporting role may be sufficient. Please include the requested end date so the access owner can review the request.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

SHARED CASE

Two cloud options cost $800 and $1,050 per month in a planning estimate. Only the second estimate includes backup storage.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Useful expressions

Both options ..., but ... .

Option A ..., whereas option B ... .

The comparison depends on ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

The estimates do not yet cover the same items. The $1,050 option includes backup storage; the $800 option does not. Let's compare equivalent configurations before recommending one.

Second round

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management

SHARED CASE

A patch reached 180 of 200 managed laptops. Twelve were offline; eight reported installation errors. A manager asks if deployment is complete.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is ... .

The next update will cover ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

The patch is installed on 180 laptops. Twelve were offline and eight returned errors. Deployment is not complete; I'll separate those groups in the follow-up report.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response

SHARED CASE

An analyst notices an unusual sign-in alert and sends it to the response team. The account owner has not yet confirmed the activity.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is ... .

The record shows ... .

Please confirm who has accepted ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm handing over an unusual sign-in alert. The timestamp and alert details are attached; the account owner's confirmation is pending. Please acknowledge receipt and confirm who will coordinate the investigation.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication

SHARED CASE

A change notice gave the wrong maintenance date. It said Tuesday, but the approved window is Thursday. Users have already received it.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for ... . The correct information is ... .

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses ... .

Cover this until after your first attempt

Please disregard the Tuesday date in my earlier notice. The approved maintenance window is Thursday. I'm sorry for the confusion; the corrected notice below includes the exact time and time zone.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations

SHARED CASE

A service dashboard shows normal server CPU usage, but users report slow checkout. A colleague says the dashboard proves the service is healthy.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means ... .

The difference is that ... .

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

CPU usage tells us about one part of the system. It does not measure the whole checkout experience. Let's compare it with request latency and errors for the affected period.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.